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Leveraging Databricks Genie for Real Business Impact

Samantha Cruz

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Nice to meet you!



My name is Samantha

- Isolutions Senior Data Engineer
- Public Speaker.
  - 8 years in Data.
  - 5 years working with Databricks.
- Databricks Technical Instructor
- Based in Barcelona

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Agenda

- What Databricks Genie is?
- How to build a Genie Space.
  - Create
  - Setup
  - Monitor
- Genie Curation & Best Practices
- Business Impact
- Demo

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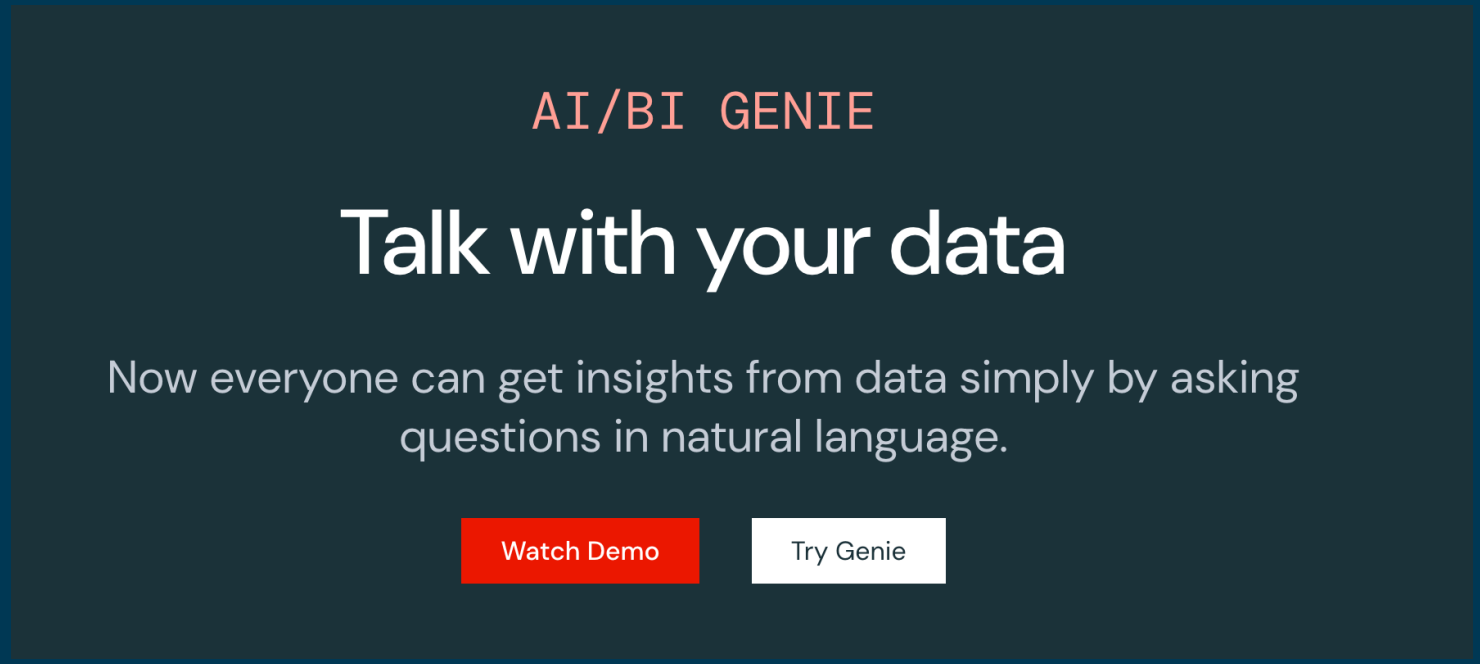
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What Databricks Genie is?

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What Genie is?

- Genie is a Business Intelligence tool. It is a natural language assistant that converts business questions into SQL queries and visual results.
- Enables non-technical users to explore data without writing SQL.
- Public Preview on March/25 and Generally Available in June/25



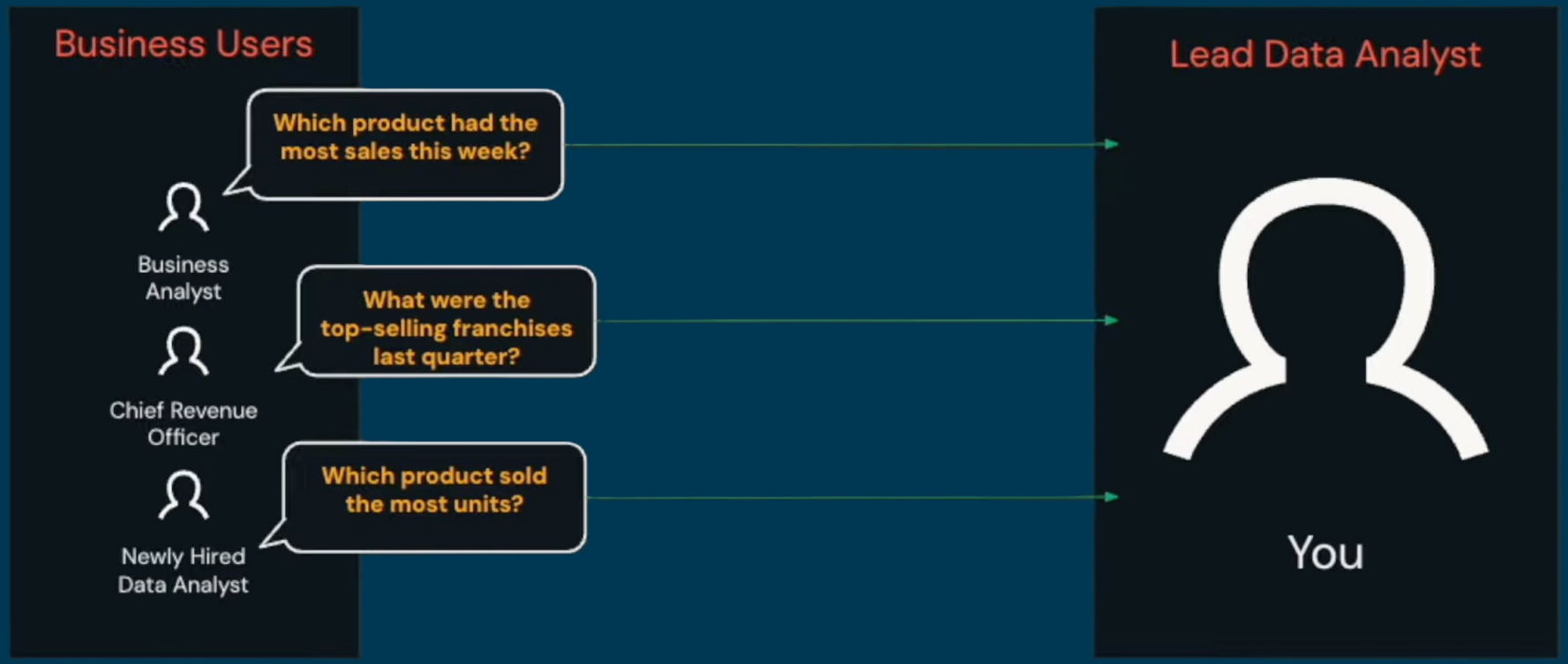
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What Genie can do for you?

- **Conversational analytics**
  Ask questions in natural language and get answers immediately
- **AI tailored to your business**
  Genie incorporates unique context for your data from the broader platform
- **Governed and secure**
  Fully governed data, with results secured by your Unity Catalog policies
- **Accessible anywhere**
  Embed in custom apps via APIs, pair with AI/BI Dashboards

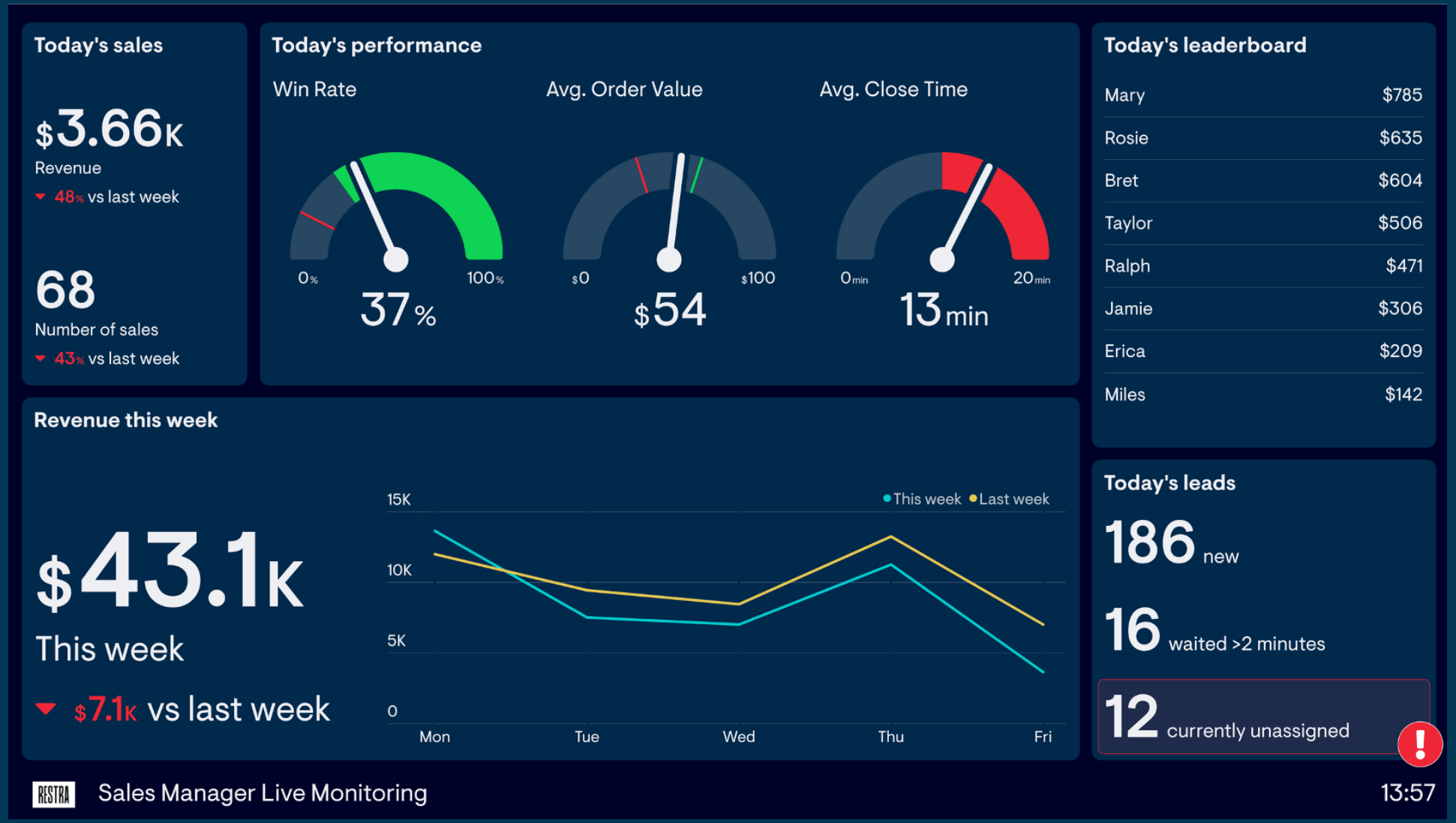
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What Genie can do for you?



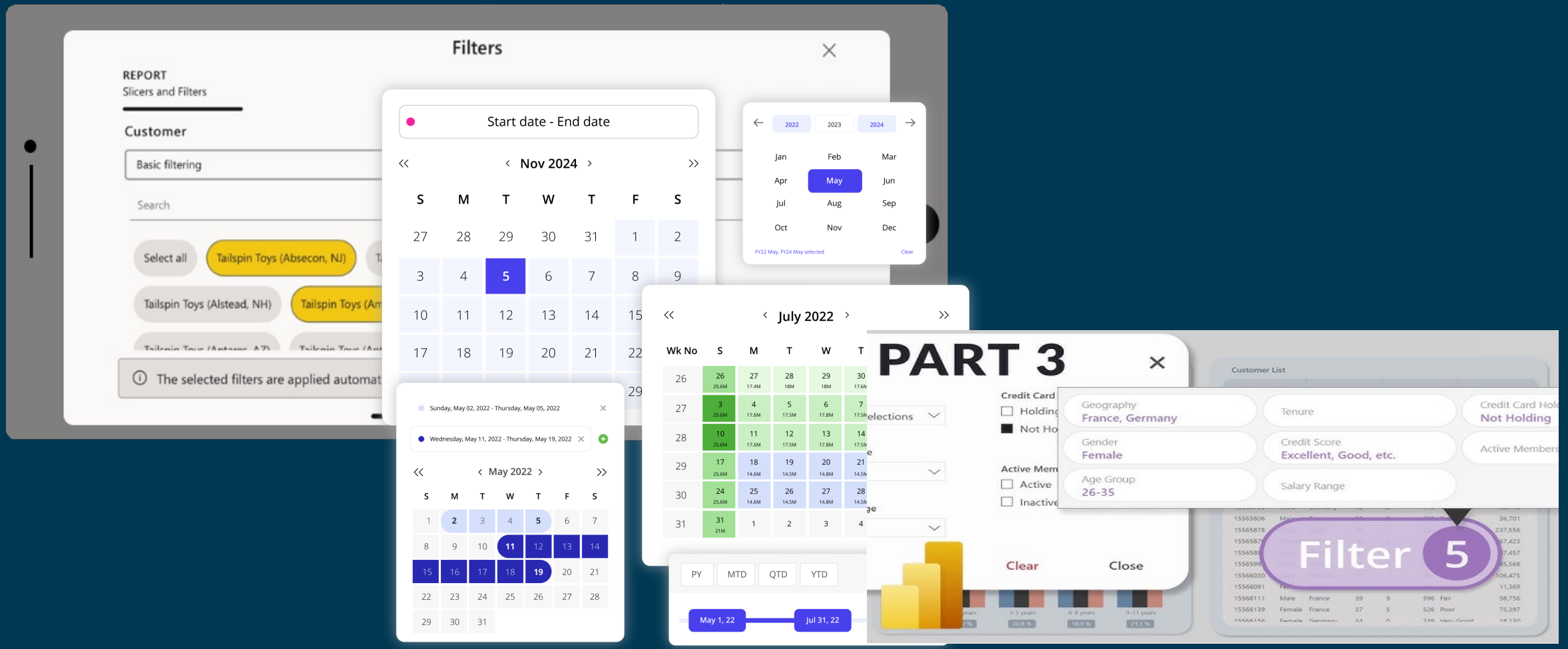
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What Genie can do for you?



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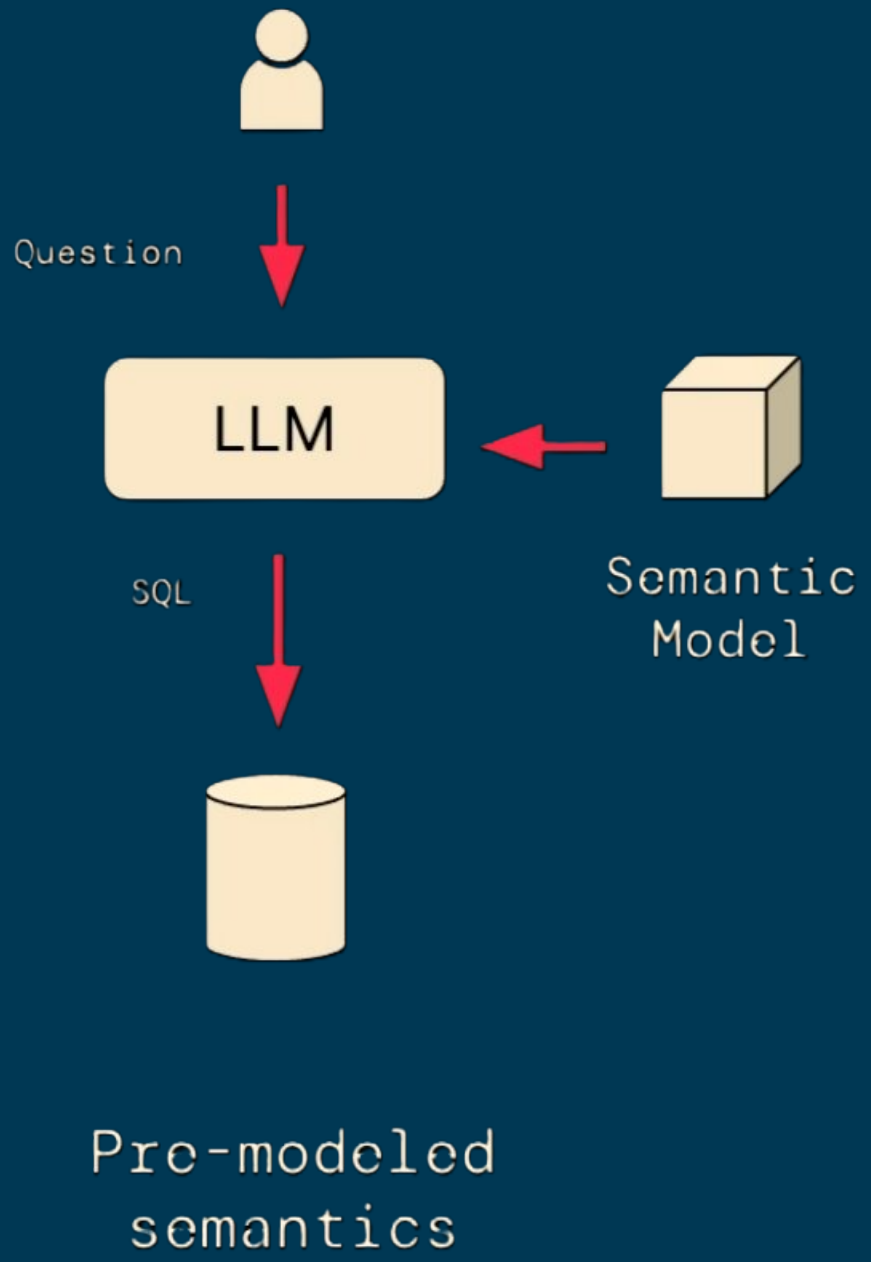
What Genie can do for you?



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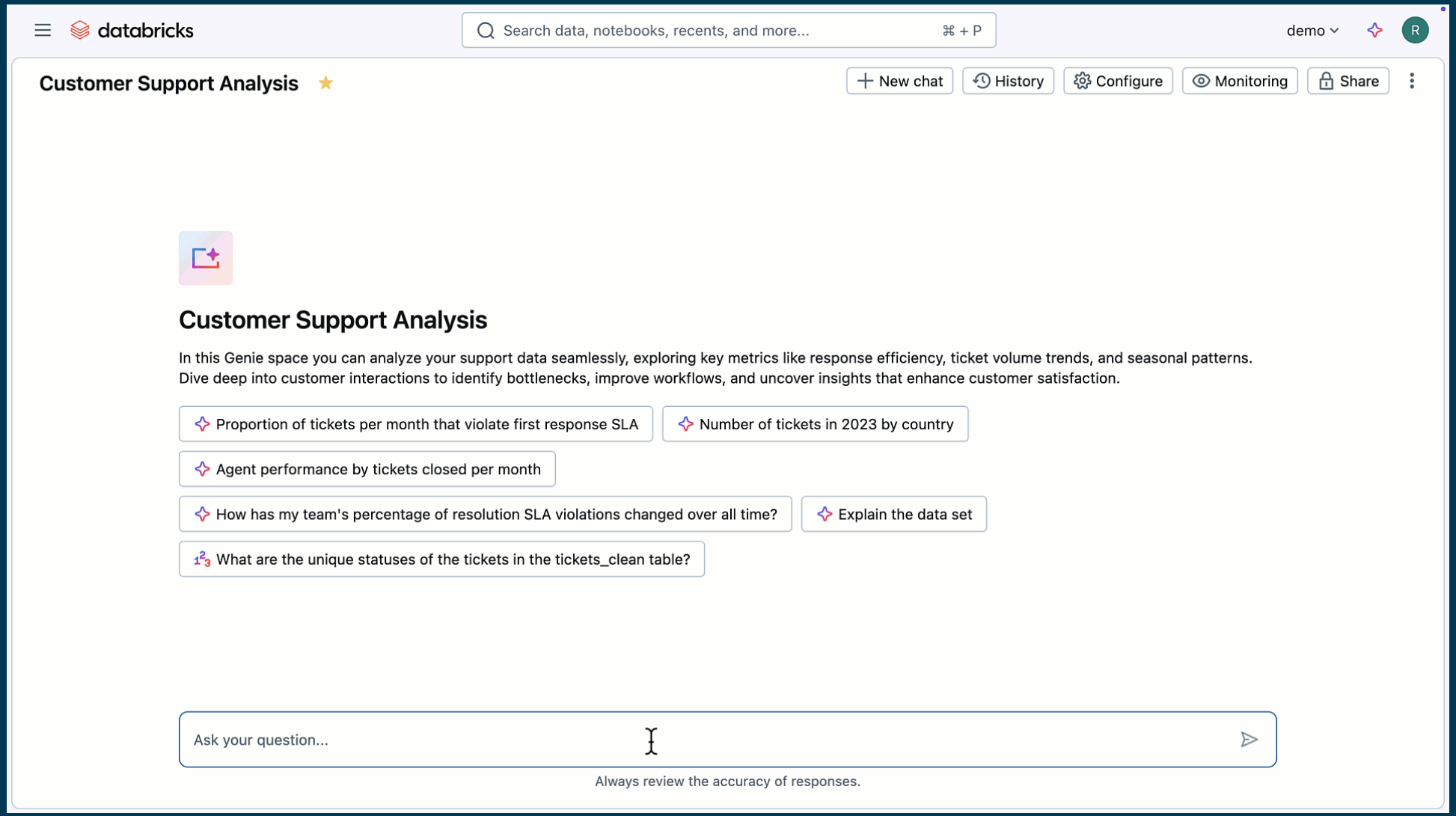
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Conventional Text2SQL



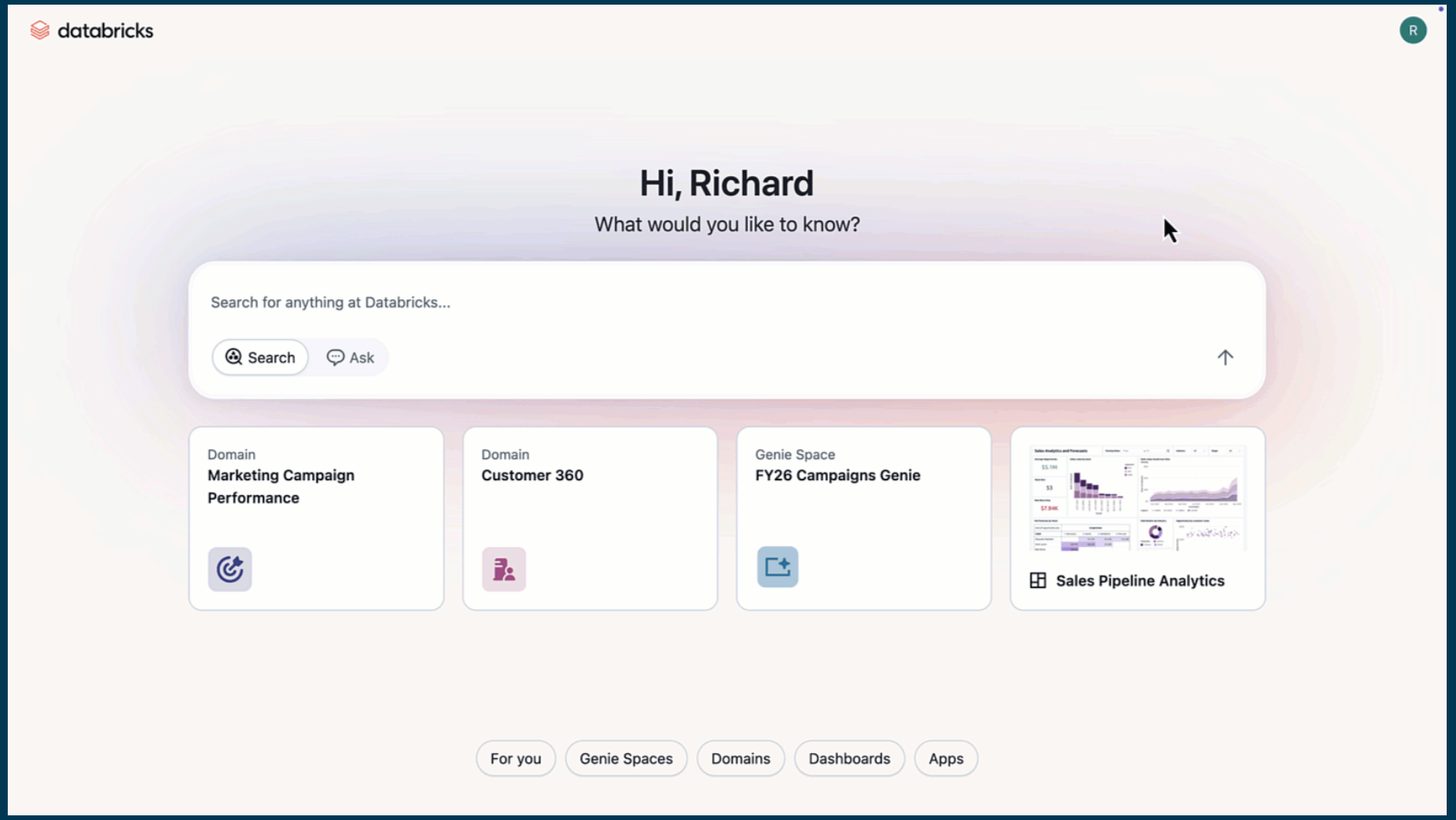
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What Genie can do for you?



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What Genie can do for you?



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Your question

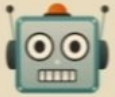
"Total sales that we closed + won, by year"

Determine relevant context

Could be (any combination of):

- Data
- Instructions
- Example SQL Queries
- ...

Text-to-SQL LLM



"Reflect" on answer

Determine best answer modality

Could be:

- Text
- Table
- Chart
- ...

Get the answer to your question

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Requirements, Limitations, Pricing

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Requirements

- Data must be registered to Unity Catalog (tables, views, or external tables).
- Use of a SQL warehouse of type Pro or Serverless; at least CAN USE permission required.
- Permissions: user must have entitlement for Databricks SQL workspace, data access (SELECT), and appropriate Genie-space ACLs (e.g., CAN EDIT, CAN RUN).

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Limitations

- Limited adoption constraints: up to 25 tables/views per Genie space.
- Throughput limits: max ~20 questions/minute per workspace for chat, and ~5 questions/min with API

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Pricing

- There is **no separate license fee** for Genie when you are a Databricks SQL customer.
- Billing is based on compute usage (SQL warehouse usage) rather than a separate token-based charge

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How to build a Genie Space

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How to build a Genie Space

Focused Topic and Data

- Each Genie space should be topic specific
- Use clean, well-documented Unity Catalog tables and metadata.

Add Instructions

- Authors can guide and teach Genie
- Provide general instructions and sample SQL statements

Accuracy Validation

- Authors and trusted business users test expected questions
- Apply improvements to the instructions

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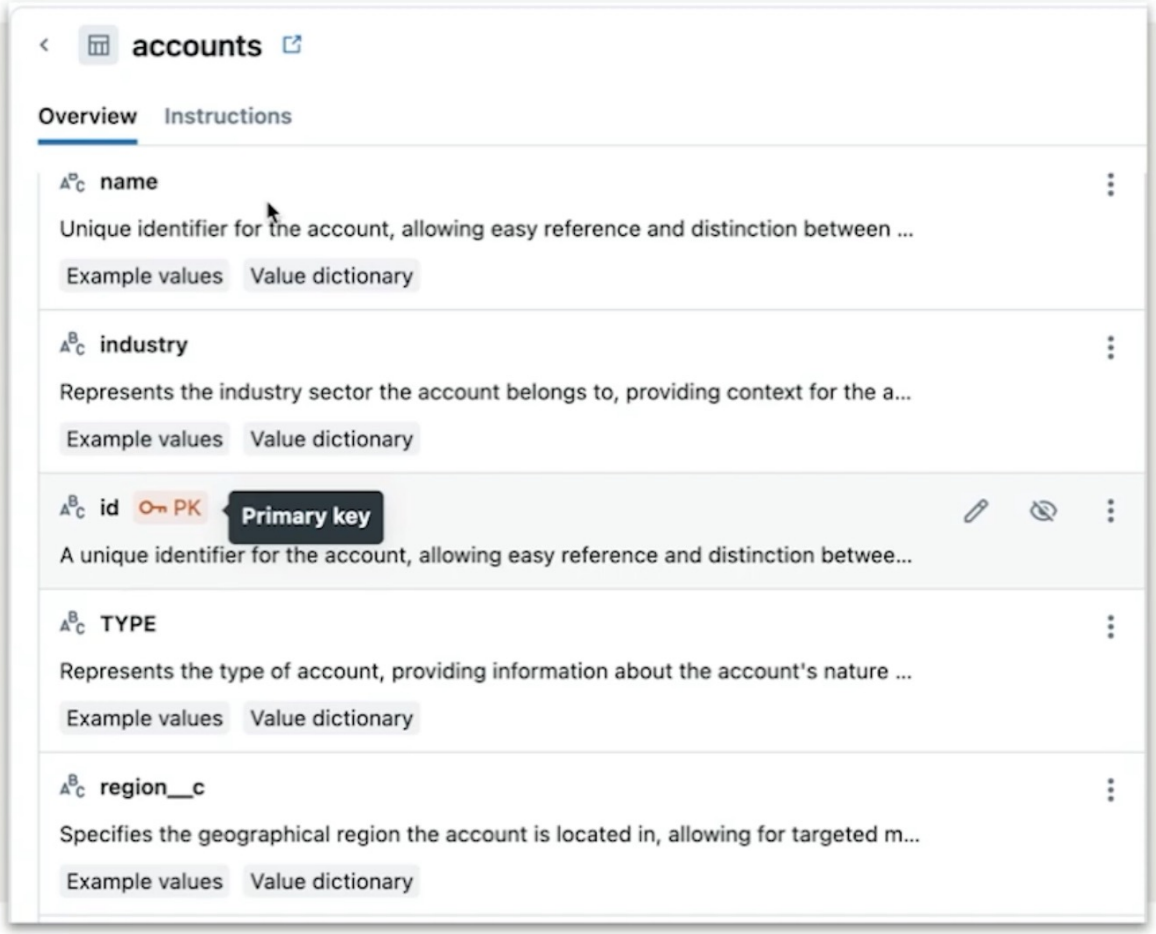
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Genie Curation
&
Best Practices

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Storage modes and query strategy



Focused Datasets

Focused and non-conflicting datasets is key to Genie's ability to generate accurate SQL

Leverages Unity Catalog Metadata

Table/column descriptions, Primary/Foreign Key relationships, column stats NEW!, example values NEW!

NEW! Value Dictionaries

Genie maps misphrased or alternative prompt values to the correct data values to return accurate results

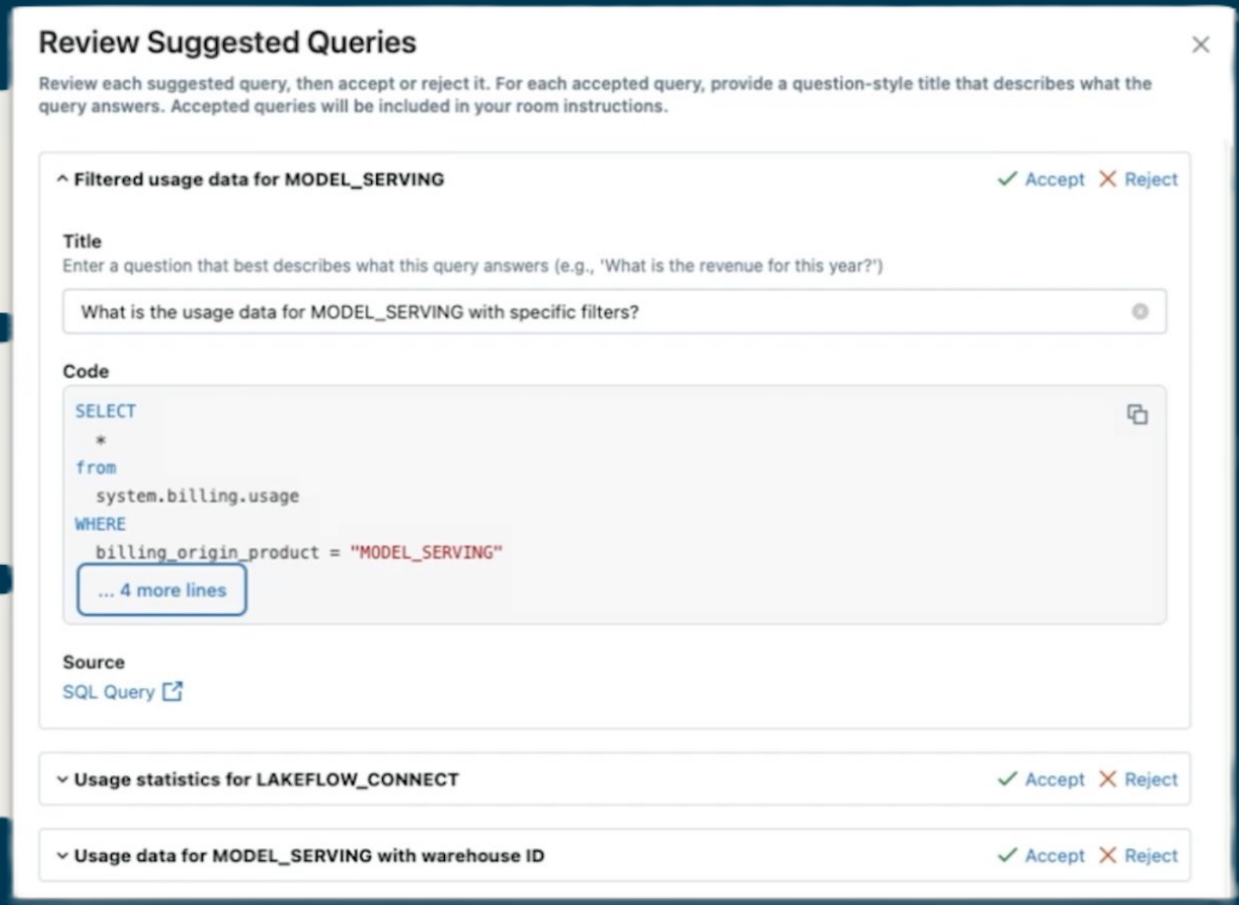
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Add Relevant Queries

Example SQL is applied dynamically to guide Genie on relevant user prompts

Add a natural language question that reflects what a business user would ask

NEW! Data Intelligence Platform will now suggest popular queries to authors



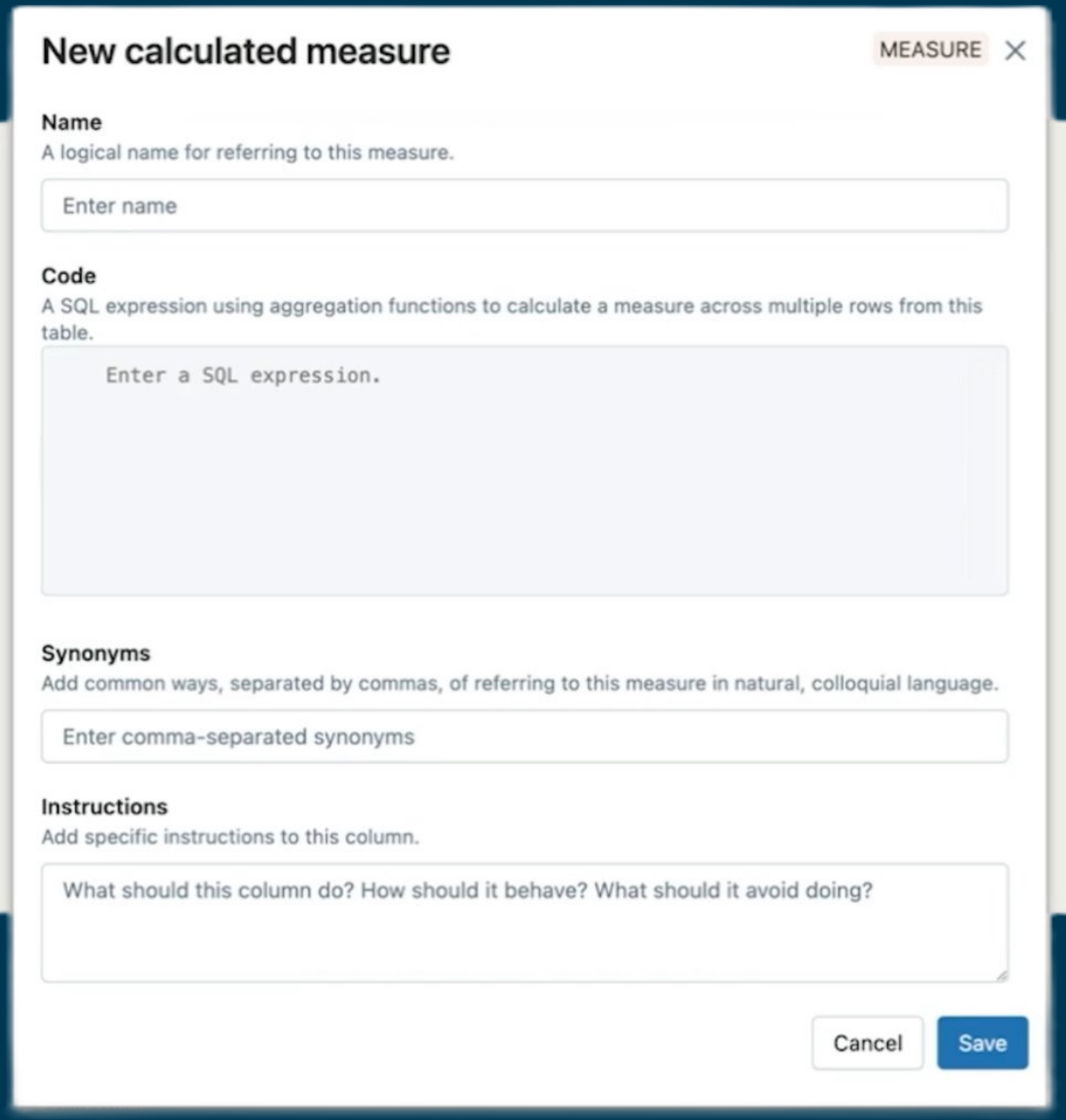
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Business Context: measures, synonyms, instructions

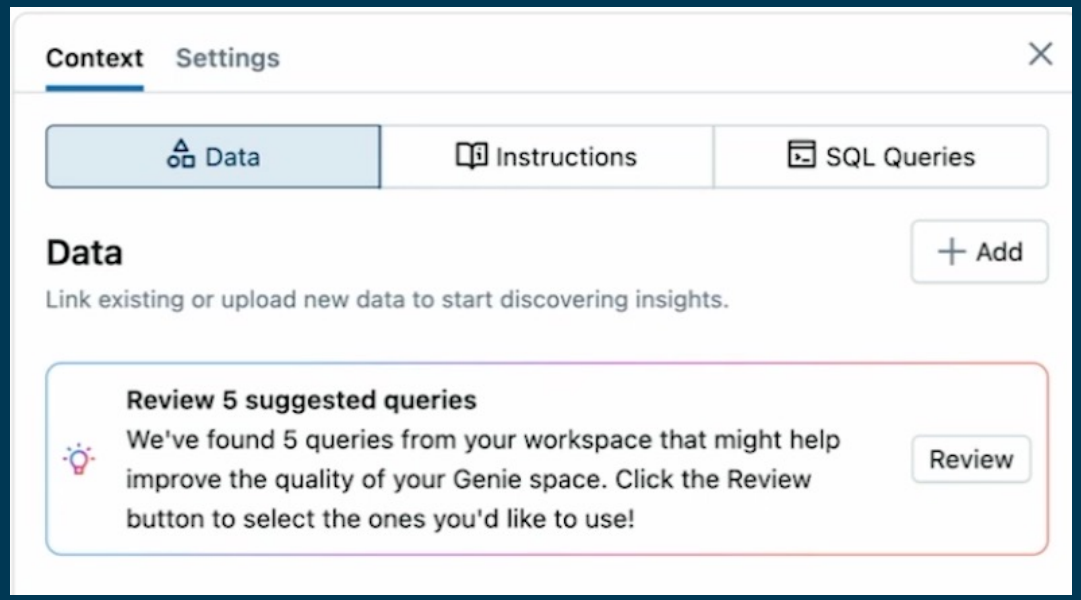
Intuitive Authoring
Structured inputs guide authors to add clearer, more complete context

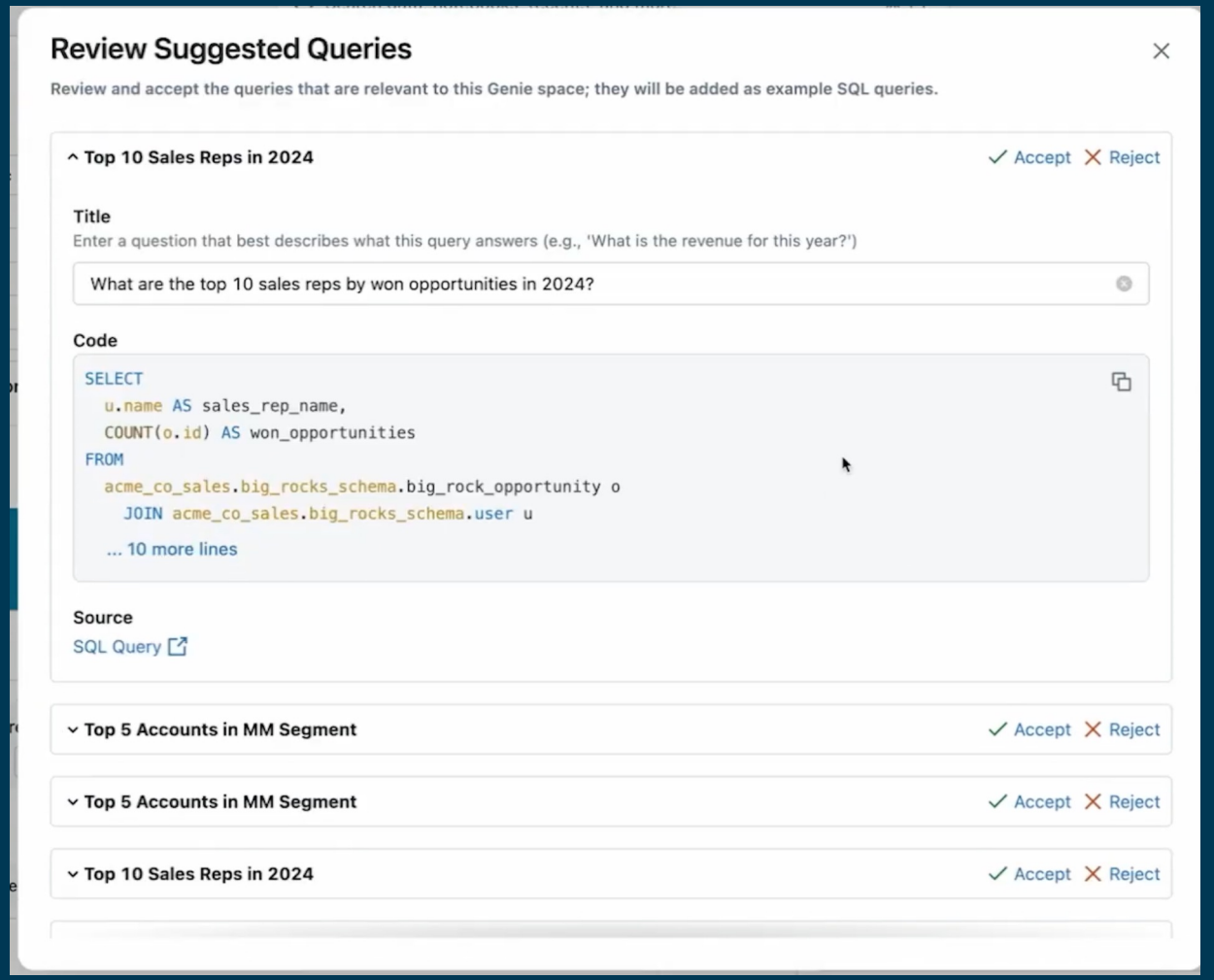
Denser Context
SQL expressions capture business context more efficiently and use less context space

Enhances Genie's RAG
Structured inputs replaces general text, enabling more selective context per prompt



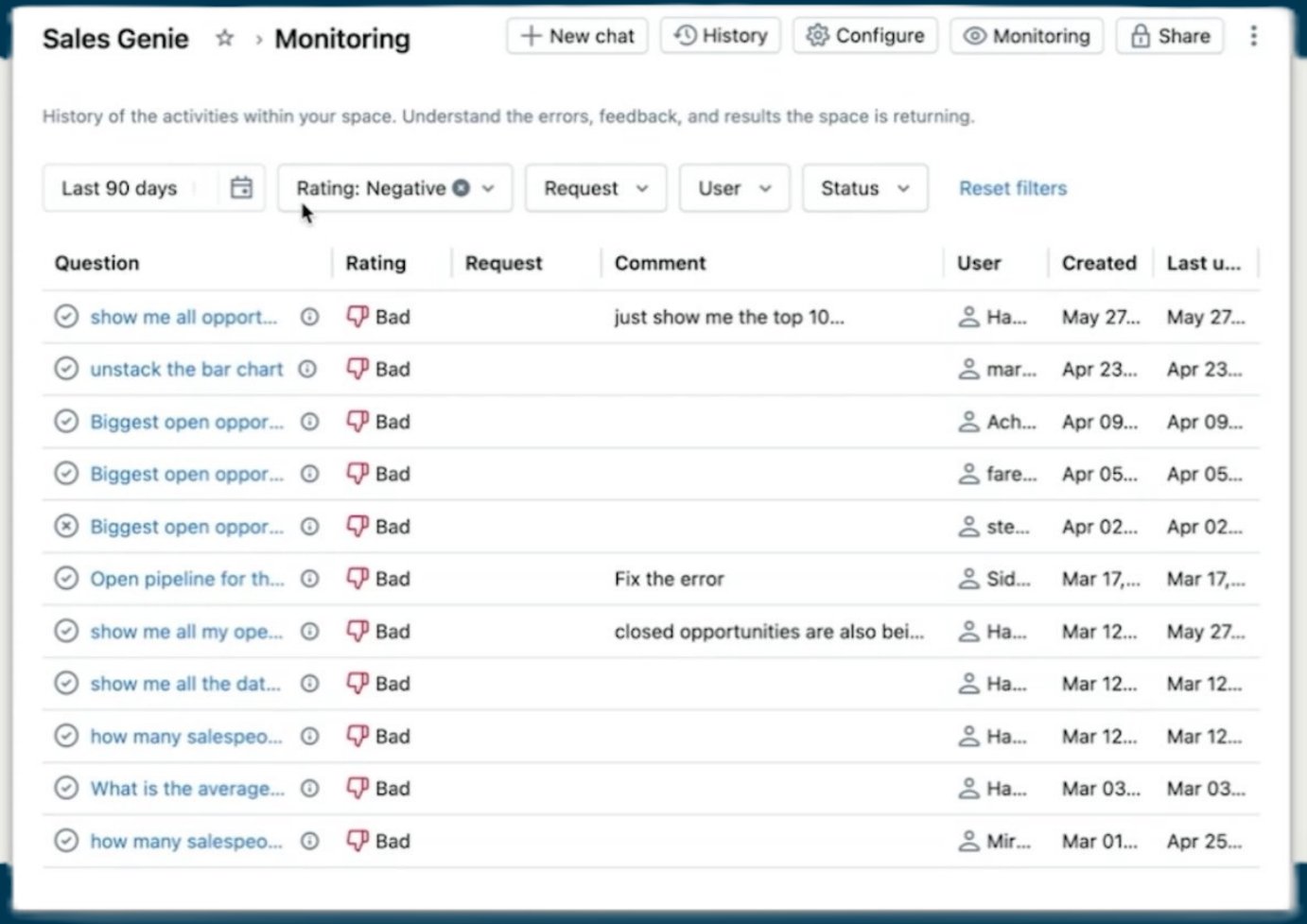
Learn from context





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Monitor User Feedback



Monitoring Tab

Track usage and feedback to guide improvements. Thumbs up/down don't auto-update the space; authors review first.

Genie Audit Logs

Set up Alerts to trigger email notifications on specific actions (request review, thumbs down, etc)

Continuous Improvement

Add new questions to Benchmarks, improve Genie context, rerun Benchmarks, repeat

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Business Impact

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Databricks Customers are already using Genie

Top organizations use AI/BI Genie

SEGA®

"We're using Databricks AI/BI Genie to help decision-makers ask ad hoc questions in real time about consumer behavior without having to depend on our data experts to construct dashboards and queries."

Felix Baker
Head of Data Services, SEGA Europe

Read the full story →



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Grupo Casas Bahia

- One of the biggest retail companies in Brazil
- The brand Casas Bahia traces back to 1952, when it was founded.
- It has approximately 30,387 full-time employees.
- The group’s revenue for 2019 was approximately R$ 29.8 billion.
- Like many traditional business, they've been investing on digitalization

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Grupo Casas Bahia

Minutes

To analyze data — down from 5–6 hours

Forward-looking

Instead of historical decision-making

107

Nonengineering employees upskilled to transform data into insights

> AI/BI Genie is the key to our data democratization strategy. It ensures that everyone, regardless of their background, can access the insights they need to perform at their best.
>
> **– Cezar Steinz, Data Operations Manager, Grupo Casas Bahia**

Integrated with Teams



Key Takeways

- **AI/BI Genie reduces workload on data teams by enabling users to self-serve insights**
- **Improve non-technical teams' productivity**
- **Start small and focused and expand incrementally**
- **Annotate and document the data thoroughly**
- **Instruct AI/BI Genie with SQL examples and general instructions**
- **Train users on how to formulate questions and provide proper context**
- **Gather feedback and refine the data and instructions**

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Demo

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Thank you

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